

name in case the marriage doesn't work out for some reason. Should I?

ANSWER: Absolutely not. Prenuptial agreements are the seeds that grow into bitterness later. God directs a man to provide for his family (1 Timothy 5:8) and a wife to be subject (literally, give all esteem) to her husband (Ephesians 5:22). If the inheritance is from your father and he doesn't want you to merge it with your future spouse's assets, you would be better off giving it back or not getting married.

In our generation, we're not very good about keeping vows. A vow is a promise, and when you get married, that promise says, "I irrevocably and forevermore commit myself to you." We're a "if it feels alright, do it" society. So if it doesn't work out, we can always get out of it. That is not God's way. I would encourage you not to get married if that is your attitude. You'd be doing your partner a grave disservice.

If you don't believe in your heart that God has created you to be one with your spouse as long as you both shall live, through good and bad, through riches or poverty, even through anger and hurt—stay single. If you think you're not going to get angry at each other from time to time, you're probably fooling yourselves. There will be times when you'll get very angry with each other, but if you have that irrevocable commitment from the Lord inside that says, "This is forever," you'll stick it out and grow stronger.

When you get married, God says it's a union of two people into one (Genesis 2:24). God's Word also says that you must first surrender your life to the Lord Jesus Christ in order to be saved. If either of you have never done that, make that your first step.

NOTE: If you feel you have other questions that need answered before you get married, I recommend my book *Answers to Your Family's Financial Questions*, published by Focus On The Family. Copies are available in most Christian bookstores.